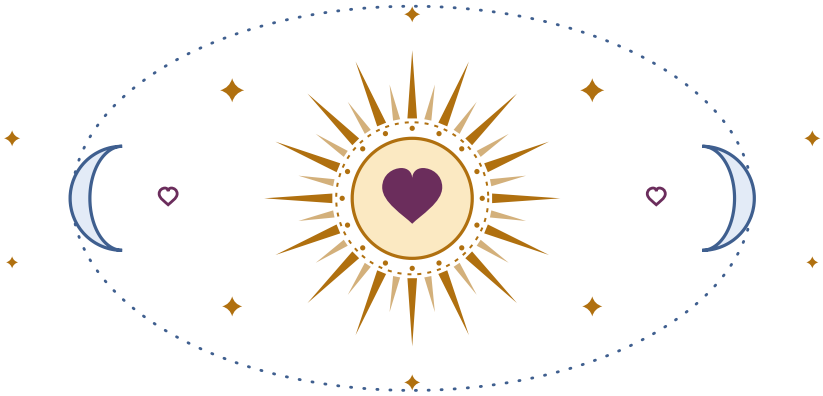


sola · lore · luno · lira

SUN · HEART · MOON · SONG

# Liraasa

## AN INVITATION

*To a language made for singing*

# A song before anything else

> Maivo de lunosavali loki ke su taivo de rezari.
>
> *My moonlit kiss still rests upon your lips.*
>
> Li velumelo loki lirala taivo de nole ultra li navu.
>
> *The music of the spheres still sings your name beyond the sky.*
>
> The Goddess's Lament, lines 12 and 13

These two lines come from *Nemelira de devi*, The Goddess's Lament. A goddess sings to the one she loves, who fell from the sky and became mortal. By the end of this booklet you will read the whole song, word by word.

## The name

liraasa

*"song of the first stars"*

The word for song is lira. Raised to its highest degree it becomes liraasa, song of the first stars, and that is the language's name. Four words carry most of its imagery: sola sun, lore heart, luno moon, lira song.

Liraasa is a language centred on a goddess, and it was built for singing. Its vowels are pure, most of its words end on an open vowel, and every word leans on the same syllable, so a melody always knows where to land.

**LISTEN FIRST**

The album *Liraasa: Songs of the First Stars* sets Liraasa to music. Hear a song before you read about one.

music.apple.com/us/album/liraasa-songs-of-the-first-stars/6824147719

# Words English doesn’t have

Some feelings take English a whole sentence. Liraasa gives them a word, and each word is two older words joined, so you can see how the meaning was made.

## loterotelne

lotero other + telne story

the realization that every stranger lives a story as deep as your own

## lorevuzi

lore heart + vuzi expectation

the sense that one is about to fall in love

## bakovani

bako break + vani beauty

the beauty of broken and imperfect things

## aurumimeyi

aurumi yellow + meyi mend

mending with gold; a wound made beautiful

## lasomambi

laso peaceful quiet + mambi moment

a meaningful pause; the space between notes

## nemeamor

neme sorrow + amor love

grief remade as love

## vanineme

vani beauty + neme sorrow

the sorrow of beautiful things passing

## momvilavi

momvi loss + lavi joy

joy after loss

## sabesuru

sabe knowing + suru feeling

feeling understood

## melolavi

melo music + lavi joy

ecstasy brought on by music

# How it sounds

Liraasa is spelled exactly as it is sung. Nothing is silent, and nothing changes its sound from one word to the next.

- **Five pure vowels**, *a e i o u*, as in Italian or Spanish. Every vowel is its own syllable: daigo is da-i-go, three syllables.
- **Three letters to watch.** *c* is always "ch": cilni, city, is "chil-ni". *r* is a single tap of the tongue, as in Spanish *pero*. *g* is always hard, as in "go": gase.
- **The weight falls on the second-to-last syllable**: LI-ra, lu-no-LU-mi, ma-I-vo.

### Kube taivo relnura

When you return: one way to set it




The big dots are the strong beats: `KU be ta I vo rel NU ra`. They fall on every third syllable, so the line moves in three, like a waltz.

Every word falls from its strong syllable to a light last one, and the small words are light all through. Put the strong syllables on the strong beats and the line sings itself.

**A SINGER'S FREEDOM**

In song, neighbouring vowels may share one note. daigo can be sung da-i-go or dai-go; navuasa, the firmament, na-vu-a-sa or na-vua-sa. The spelling never changes. The melody chooses.

# Saying hello

**yeko** hello

**voge** goodbye / parting

**zabo** yes / affirmative

**kepi** no

**fisa** please

**yade** sorry / pardon

**lorejuba** thank you

And a first conversation. Under each word is its meaning; the pages that follow show how the words are built.

**A**

Yeko, sora!
hello friend

*Hello, friend!*

**B**

Yeko! Taivo lirala ki?
hello you sing (question)

*Hello! Do you sing?*

**A**

Zabo. Maivo lirala muya-krono.
yes I sing often

*Yes. I sing often.*

**B**

Fisa, lirala!
please sing

*Please sing!*

*A sings.*

**B**

Lorejuba ala taivo.
thank you to you

*Thank you, from the heart.*

**A**

Voge, sora.
goodbye friend

*Goodbye, friend.*

# One root, seven words

| Li | daigo | ka | baba | dorbi, | ata | maivo | sulnosia | taivo | en | li | lumiasa. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| the | death | is (always) | a | door | and | I | wait | you | in | the | light-ASC |

*Death is a door, and I wait for you in the Divine Light.* — The Lament, line 11

Death is a door, and so is the word for it: daigo opens onto six more.

Every root in Liraasa can take seven shapes. Here is daigo, death, in all of them:

THE THING ITSELF
**daigo**
death

RAISED TO ITS HIGHEST `-ASA`
**daigoasa**
ultimate death, final death

TURNED AROUND `-NA`
**daigona**
resurrection

TO DO IT
**daigoda**
to die

DESCRIBING `-SAN`
**daigosan**
mortal

DESCRIBING, RAISED `-ASASAN`
**daigoasasan**
of the final death

DESCRIBING, TURNED `-NASAN`
**daigonasan**
death-ending, healing, life-giving; deathless; immortal

The shapes are made by rule, but each meaning is the language's own: the highest degree of death is the final death, and death turned around is daigona, resurrection.

Not every root fills every shape. A shape is a word only when the language has given it a meaning: garvu, lion, has no verb, and ~~garvuga~~ stays empty.

## A word, not a "not"

daigona is a word of its own, resurrection, not "no death". To say *not*, Liraasa uses a separate small word, ne, set just before what it denies:

| Li | harmadesi | tivrota | taivo, | ata | li | kronorivla | ne | teklata. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| the | temptation | hold | you | and | the | flow of time | not | stop |

*Temptation holds you, and the flow of time does not stop.* — The Lament, line 6

# Words from words

Two words make a third. The second word is what the thing *is*; the first tells you what kind.

luno moon + lumi light = lunolumi moonlight

The Lament is full of them:

sola sun + nevra descent = solanevra sunset

krono time + rivla flow = kronorivla the flow of time

velu star + melo music = velumelo the music of the spheres

ramu memory + duha longing = ramuduha longing for what is gone

velu star + solo stone = velusolo meteorite; a fallen star-stone

A word made this way can be used again. mavolumi, soul, is mavo mind + lumi light: the light of the mind. Add miga, relation, and you have mavolumimiga, a soulbond.

# The image engine

Some words join so often that Liraasa lets them pair freely. Take any of 57 words for a colour, a season or a feeling, and any of 31 words for a thing: every pair is a word, 1,767 in all, and you can read its meaning straight off its parts.

The first word lends its colour; the second is the thing. So lunosavali, moon + kiss, is the moonlit kiss of the Lament, and here are a few more:

veluvulra starlit + wound

starlit wound; a wound that remembers distant stars

fojosavali snow-softened + kiss

snow-softened kiss; an intimate kiss recalling falling snow

veluvilne starlit + eye

starlit eyes; eyes brightened or clouded by distant stars

sevuhavli sea-borne + breath

sea-borne breath; a breath filled with the sea

norunulu dream-born + path

dream-born path; a trail shaped by dreams

ramubelda remembered + bell

remembered bell; a bell stirred by memory

vesnolira twilight-soft + song

twilight-soft song; a melody given the color of evening

lumimanli luminous + hand

luminous hand; hands marked by light

### Try it

Join each pair into one word, and say what it means.

1. merno dawn-fresh + vaye wind = ?
2. noru dream-born + havli breath = ?
3. fojo snow-softened + belda bell = ?

1. merrovaye: dawn-fresh wind; air moving with the character of morning · 2. norunhavli: dream-born breath; a breath filled with dreams · 3. fojobelda: snow-softened bell; a bell stirred by falling snow

# Just enough grammar to read a song

## The order is English order

Who, then what happens, then to what. The describing word comes first: daigosan yuge, a mortal body.

> Taivo po yugeya baba daigosan yuge, ata li veluri po lasola.
> you (past) embody a mortal body and the star-PL (past) hush
>
> *You took on a mortal body, and the stars fell silent.* — The Lament, line 2

## Two ways to say “is”

ka is for what is so by nature; ke is for what is so for now. English needs a phrase for what Liraasa says in one small word.

> Taivo de mavolumi ka velusan, nara taivo de yuge ke vulrasan.
> you of soul is (always) starlit but you of body is (now) wounded
>
> *Your soul is starlit by nature, but your body is wounded for now.* — The Lament, line 4
>
> ---
>
> The soul is starlit for ever (ka); the body is wounded for a while (ke).

## “Not” goes first

ne stands just before what it denies. Before povi, can, it makes *cannot*.

> Kasa maivo ka devi, maivo ne povi venreva ala taivo.
> because I is (always) goddess I not can come to you
>
> *Because I am a goddess, I cannot come to you.* — The Lament, line 10

## A question ends in ki

Say it as a statement, then add ki.

> Taivo futu relnura ki?
> you will return (question)
>
> *Will you come back?*

# Past, future, and “of”

## Past and future are small words

A verb never changes its ending for time. po before it means it happened; futu means it will. With neither, it is happening now.

> Kube taivo relnura, maivo futu lomola taivo, ata li lektaasa futu venreva.
> when you return I will embrace you and the gathering-ASC will come
>
> *When you return, I will embrace you, and the great reunion of all souls will come.*
>
> — The Lament, line 16
>
> The song begins with po, she *descended*, and ends with futu twice: I *will* embrace you, the reunion *will* come.

## Whose is it?

de means *of*. Usually the owner comes second, as in English “the bread of the city”. But when the first word is *I*, *you* or someone’s name, that person is the owner. A word like *father* is not a name here: father’s bread is the bread *of* father.

| Liraasa | English |
|---|---|
| maivo de lira | my song |
| taivo de lira | your song |
| li bumre de pilo | father’s bread |
| li bumre de li cilni | the bread of the city |

That is how the Lament opens: Maivo de amor, my love.

### Try it

The Goddess says maivo de amor, my love. How does she say *your heart*? (Heart is lore.)

taivo de lore, as in line 8 of the Lament

THE SONG

# Nemelira de devi

*The Goddess's Lament*

| | LIRAASA | ENGLISH |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Maivo de amor, taivo po nevrania da li navuasa ala li teru gase baba velusolo. | *My love, you descended from the firmament to the earth like a falling star-stone.* |
| 2 | Taivo po yugeya baba daigosan yuge, ata li veluri po lasola. | *You took on a mortal body, and the stars fell silent.* |
| 3 | Eli-krono taivo ke lemvosan en li cilniri de li nelari. | *Now you are weary in the cities of humankind.* |
| 4 | Taivo de mavolumi ka velusan, nara taivo de yuge ke vulrasan. | *Your soul is starlit by nature, but your body is wounded for now.* |
| 5 | Maivo vuda vimova taivo de timruri raho ralnora gase renli. | *In dreams I see your tears, which fall like rain.* |
| 6 | Li harmadesi tivrota taivo, ata li kronorivla ne teklata. | *Temptation holds you, and the flow of time does not stop.* |
| 7 | Taivo lemula li lorenuravu de li nelari ata li vemineme. | *You learn the anguish of humankind and the sorrow of the world.* |
| 8 | Taivo de manliri yanbaya, ata taivo de lore ke lemvosan. | *Your hands grow old, and your heart is weary.* |
| 9 | Maivo lavbula vobi taivo hupi li solanevra, nara maivo de valla ke lasosan. | *I pray for you above the sunset, but my voice is silent.* |
| 10 | Kasa maivo ka devi, maivo ne povi venreva ala taivo. | *Because I am a goddess, I cannot come to you.* |
| 11 | Li daigo ka baba dorbi, ata maivo sulnosia taivo en li lumiasa. | *Death is a door, and I wait for you in the Divine Light.* |
| 12 | Maivo de lunosavali loki ke su taivo de rezari. | *My moonlit kiss still rests upon your lips.* |
| 13 | Li velumelo loki lirala taivo de nole ultra li navu. | *The music of the spheres still sings your name beyond the sky.* |
| 14 | Maivo de ramuduha ka gase dendusan gase li vamrisevu. | *My longing for what is gone is as deep as the dark between the stars.* |
| 15 | Taivo kersoka en li narvo gase baba nolsakerso su li lamsa. | *You grow in the darkness like new shoots upon the ashes.* |
| 16 | Kube taivo relnura, maivo futu lomola taivo, ata li lektaasa futu venreva. | *When you return, I will embrace you, and the great reunion of all souls will come.* |

Sing it through once. The pages that follow take it word by word.

THE CENTREPIECE

# Nemelira de devi, word by word

*The Goddess's Lament* again, now with its meaning under every word. ASC marks a word raised to its highest, PL more than one.

1 Maivo de amor, taivo po nevrania da li navuasa ala li teru gase baba velusolo.
I of love you (past) descend from the sky-ASC to the earth as a meteorite

*My love, you descended from the firmament to the earth like a falling star-stone.*

Maivo de amor, my love: the Goddess is speaking. navuasa is navu, sky, raised to its highest: the firmament. gase baba …, like a …, makes a simile.

2 Taivo po yugeya baba daigosan yuge, ata li veluri po lasola.
you (past) embody a mortal body and the star-PL (past) hush

*You took on a mortal body, and the stars fell silent.*

A mortal body: the describing word comes first.

3 Eli-krono taivo ke lemvosan en li cilniri de li nelari.
now you is (now) tired in the city-PL of the person-PL

*Now you are weary in the cities of humankind.*

`-ri` makes more than one: cilni, city, cilniri, cities; nela, person, nelari, people.

4 Taivo de mavolumi ka velusan, nara taivo de yuge ke vulrasan.
you of soul is (always) starlit but you of body is (now) wounded

*Your soul is starlit by nature, but your body is wounded for now.*

ka by nature, ke for now.

5 Maivo vuda vimova taivo de timruri raho ralnora gase renli.
I in a dream see you of tear-PL which fall as rain

*In dreams I see your tears, which fall like rain.*

vuda tells you how the singer knows: she sees this in a dream. raho, which, begins a description of the tears.

6 Li harmadesi tivrota taivo, ata li kronorivla ne teklata.
the temptation hold you and the flow of time not stop

*Temptation holds you, and the flow of time does not stop.*

ne comes right before what it denies.

7 Taivo lemula li lorenuravu de li nelari ata li vemineme.
you learn the anguish of the person-PL and the world-weariness
*You learn the anguish of humankind and the sorrow of the world.*

lorenuravu, heart + ache, is anguish; vemineme, world + sorrow, is world-weariness.

8 Taivo de manliri yanbaya, ata taivo de lore ke lemvosan.
you of hand-PL age and you of heart is (now) tired
*Your hands grow old, and your heart is weary.*

9 Maivo lavbula vobi taivo hupi li solanevra, nara maivo de valla ke lasosan.
I pray for you above the sunset but I of voice is (now) silent
*I pray for you above the sunset, but my voice is silent.*

vobi, for, and hupi, above, come before what they govern. solanevra, sun + going down, is sunset.

10 Kasa maivo ka devi, maivo ne povi venreva ala taivo.
because I is (always) goddess I not can come to you
*Because I am a goddess, I cannot come to you.*

ne povi: cannot.

11 Li daigo ka baba dorbi, ata maivo sulnosia taivo en li lumiasa.
the death is (always) a door and I wait you in the light-ASC
*Death is a door, and I wait for you in the Divine Light.*

lumiasa: Her Divine Light, the Goddess's own light.

12 Maivo de lunosavali loki ke su taivo de rezari.
I of moonlit kiss still is (now) on you of lip-PL
*My moonlit kiss still rests upon your lips.*

lunosavali: the moonlit kiss.

13 Li velumelo loki lirala taivo de nole ultra li navu.
the music of the spheres still sing you of name beyond the sky
*The music of the spheres still sings your name beyond the sky.*

velumelo: the music of the spheres.

14 Maivo de ramuduha ka gase dendusan gase li vamrisevu.
I of longing for what is gone is (always) as deep as the sea of space
*My longing for what is gone is as deep as the dark between the stars.*

gase … gase … is "as … as …". vamrisevu, space + sea, is the dark between the stars.

15 Taivo kersoka en li narvo gase baba nolsakerso su li lamsa.
you grow in the darkness as a new growth on the ash

*You grow in the darkness like new shoots upon the ashes.*

kersoka, to grow, is the verb of kerso, growth; nolsakerso, newness + growth, is new growth.

16 Kube taivo relnura, maivo futu lomola taivo, ata li lektaasa futu venreva.
when you return I will embrace you and the gathering-ASC will come

*When you return, I will embrace you, and the great reunion of all souls will come.*

futu twice: the song ends in the future.

# Where to go next

- **The Liraasa 4.0 Reference Grammar.** Everything this booklet left out: every rule, how to say almost anything from English, the numbers and colours, and a treasury of words for songwriters. github.com/nicolasbulgarides/Liraasa/blob/codex-latest/Liraasa_Reference_Grammar.pdf
- **The album, *Liraasa: Songs of the First Stars*.** Listen on Apple Music.

  music.apple.com/us/album/liraasa-songs-of-the-first-stars/6824147719

- **The Liraasa lexicon.** 2,462 words, and the image engine's 1,767 more, each in its seven shapes, with the whole grammar, in one file built for reading and for language tools.
  github.com/nicolasbulgarides/Liraasa/blob/codex-latest/liraasa_lexicon.json

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Liraasa was created by Peter Pietri. Follow the language, read its source, or get in touch on GitHub: github.com/nicolasbulgarides/Liraasa

## Voge, sora.

Goodbye, friend.

# On one page

## Sounds

- a e i o u: pure, each its own syllable
- c = “ch”, r = a tap, g = hard
- Weight on the second-to-last syllable

## Seven shapes

- daigo the thing itself
- daigoasa raised to its highest
- daigona turned around
- daigoda to do it
- daigosan describing
- daigoasasan describing, raised
- daigonasan describing, turned

## Word order

who · (po / futu) · (ne) · does · what · (ki)

Describing words before the thing. Two words joined: the second is the thing.

## Small words

- li the
- baba a
- de of
- ata and
- nara but
- ke / ka is (now) / is (always)
- ne not
- po did (past)
- futu will
- ki makes a question
- maivo / taivo I / you

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Liraasa 4.0 · 2026-10-26. Every Liraasa word in this booklet was checked against the lexicon.